Gmail

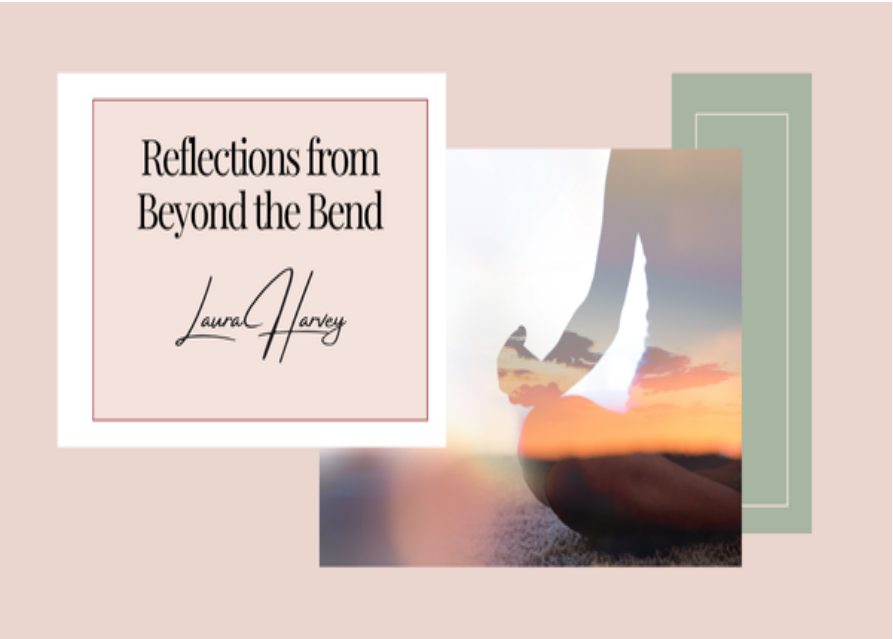
Laura Harvey <coachlharvey@gmail.com>

Hurrying to nowhere

1 message

Beyond The Bend Yoga <laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca> Sun, Nov 30, 2025 at 7:01 PM
Reply-To: laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca
To: coachlharvey@gmail.com

BEYOND THE BEND YOGA



Hello Laura

I've been noticing a specific energy in the air this week. Can you feel it?

It is a hum of urgency.

Everywhere we look right now, from our inboxes to the grocery store lineups, the message seems to be the same. Hurry. Don't miss out. Act now. Move faster.

I found myself catching that energy yesterday. My shoulders crept up toward my ears and I rushed through tasks that didn't actually need to be rushed, just because the world felt fast.

It made me pause and wonder why we feel we have to match the speed of the chaos around us.

There is something radical about choosing to move slowly when everything else is spinning. It feels like a small rebellion. It is a way of reclaiming your own peace and reminding your body that, despite the noise, you are safe here.

I hope this week's reflection offers you a little permission to unclench, exhale, and take your time.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

This Week's Wellness Wisdom

The Habit of Running

By Laura Harvey | Beyond the Bend Yoga

The teacher Thich Nhat Hanh often spoke about something he called "The Habit of Running."

He used the Sanskrit word Vāsanā to describe this. It translates to "habit energy," which is the deep-seated momentum of the past pushing us around in the present.

He observed that so many of us spend our entire lives running. We do it internally, even when we are sitting still. We run while we are eating. We run even in our sleep.

We are always leaning forward into the next moment because this momentum is so strong. It convinces us that if we just hurry fast enough, we will finally "catch up." We think once we catch up, then we can relax.

But deep down, we know the truth. The finish line keeps moving. There is always another list, another request, another role to fill.

Living in this state of constant running doesn't actually make us more efficient. It just makes us empty. It steals the texture of our lives. When we rush through making dinner, we miss the smell of the spices. When we rush through a conversation, we miss the connection.

We end up skimming the surface of our own lives.

Thich Nhat Hanh taught that as long as we are running, we are not capable of touching the peace of the present moment. We miss the sunshine, the fresh air, and the friend sitting right in front of us.

The truth is, we will never truly be "caught up." And that is good news. It means we don't have to wait for an empty to-do list to find calm. We can choose to be peaceful right now, even with things left undone.

Slowing down isn’t about falling behind. It is about deciding to inhabit the moment you are actually in.

Practice of the Week:

The Half-Speed Task

In the spirit of stopping the run, I invite you to try a very small experiment this week.

Choose one ordinary, mundane task that you usually rush through. Maybe it’s making your morning coffee, folding the laundry, or walking from your car to the front door.

And then, just for those few minutes, **do it at half-speed.**

- Notice the weight of the kettle in your hand.
- Feel the texture of the fabric as you fold it.
- Feel your heel, then your arch, then your toe strike the ground as you walk.
- Take a full breath between each movement.

Notice how your mind might want to pull you forward ("Come on, let's get this done!").

When you feel that pull, simply pause. Take a slow inhale through your nose and let it out with a soft sigh.

Remind yourself that there is nowhere else you need to be in this exact second. Feel your shoulders drop away from your ears.

That tiny pocket of slowness is where the magic lives.

Winter Session:
Planning Without Panic

Speaking of doing things without rushing, I am currently finalizing the schedule for our **Winter 2026 Session** which will begin on **January 12** and run for 12 weeks through the end of March.

All classes will be held at **Rising Moon Studio** in Sherwood Park, where we will be cozying up by the fireplace for the winter months. (And for those who need to stay home, hybrid online options will be available for all classes).

The Schedule:

- **Monday Evenings:** Somatic Vinyasa (6:00 – 7:15 pm)
- **Tuesday Mornings:** Rise & Restore (10:00 – 11:15 am)
- **Tuesday Evenings:** Restore & Reclaim (6:00 – 7:15 pm)
- **Wednesday Mornings:** Morning Stillness (10:00 – 11:15 am)

Registration Details:

For My Current Students: You have a **"Priority Window"** from now until **Sunday, December 7** to claim your current spot before I open registration to the public. If you want to continue into January, and you haven't already emailed me, simply hit **reply** to this email and tell me **"I'm in."**

For New Students: If you are not currently in a class but are hoping to join us in January, please **reply to this email with the word "Waitlist" and which class you are eyeing.**

I will be opening up the remaining spots to the Waitlist first on **Monday, December 8**. These intimate classes tend to fill quickly, so this ensures you are the first to know when space opens.

A Closing Thought

As you move into this week, remember that urgency is often just a habit, not a reality. The list will always be there tomorrow. But this moment? It is only here once. You are allowed to enjoy it.

With warmth and gratitude,

Laura 💗

Our e-mail address is:
laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca

Want to change how you receive these emails?
You can unsubscribe from this list.